

TANAH, TANAH, RUMAH • تنها، تنها، رو ماه

Land, Land, Home — Alone, Alone, Upon the Moon

one stream of sound, two poems: read the middle column aloud — an Indonesian ear hears the left-hand poem, a Persian ear the right

ENGLISH <i>a village day</i>	INDONESIAN	SHARED SOUND (IPA)	PERSIAN	ENGLISH <i>alone, toward the moon</i>
<i>prayer becomes a blurred village</i>	doa jadi desa buram	[do.(ʔ)aː.dʒaː.di.de.sa.bu.ram]	دعا جا دیده، صبورم <i>do'â jâ dide, sabur-am</i>	<i>the prayer has found its place; I am patient</i>
<i>the village day and the chickens</i>	hari desa dan ayam	[ha.ri.de.sa.daː.na.jam]	هر عید صدا نی‌ام <i>har 'id-e sadâ nay-am</i>	<i>at every feast of sound, I am the reed-flute</i>
<i>mother's matter is the foundation of the house</i>	hal ibu dasar rumah	[haː.li.bu.da.sar.ru.mah]	حالی بود، اثر رو مه <i>hâli bud, 'asar ru mah</i>	<i>there was a feeling — a trace upon the moon</i>
<i>mother's land inside an oyster</i>	tanah ibu dalam tiram	[ta.naː.hi.bu.da.lam.ti.ram]	تن آهی بود، علم، تیرم <i>tan 'âbi bud, 'alam, tir-am</i>	<i>the body was a sigh; O banner, I am the arrow</i>
<i>a moment ago, within kindness</i>	tadi dalam budi	[taː.di.da.lam.bu.di]	تا دید، علم بودی <i>tâ did, 'alam budi</i>	<i>the moment he looked, you were the banner</i>
<i>we are here; the night is a womb</i>	kita ada malam rahim	[ki.taː.ʔa.da.ma.lam.ra.him]	که تا عدم، علم، رهیم <i>ki tâ 'adam, 'alam, rah-im</i>	<i>for until nothingness, banner aloft, we are the road</i>
<i>the deer and the ash are in the house</i>	rusa dan abu di rumah	[ru.sa.daː.na.bu.di.ru.mah]	رو، صدا نبودی رو مه <i>ro, sadâ nabudi ru mah</i>	<i>go — you were not even a sound upon the moon</i>
<i>the house has already become a womb</i>	rumah sudah rahim	[ru.mə.su.də.raː.him]	روم حسود، هر آهیم <i>rum hasud, har 'âb-im</i>	<i>Rome is envious; we are every sigh</i>
<i>the land from before, and the fog</i>	tanah tadi dan kabut	[ta.nəː.taː.di.dan.ka.but]	تنها تا دید عنکبوت <i>tanbâ tâ did 'ankabut</i>	<i>alone, until the spider saw</i>
<i>land, land, home</i>	tanah tanah rumah	[ta.nəː.ta.nəː.ru.maːh]	تنها، تنها، رو ماه <i>tanbâ, tanbâ, ru mâh</i>	<i>alone, alone, upon the moon</i>



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composed by lattice search over Indonesian and Persian pronunciation lexicons: every line is a single phoneme stream that the two languages segment into different words • [ə] breathy vowel — its /h/ is heard as a coda by Indonesian (ta.nah) and as the next onset by Persian (tan.hâ)